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GS-4

READYMADE INTRODUCTIONS & CONCLUSIONS

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ETHICS
RESPECT
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ETHICS – GS4 SYLLABUS – THEMATIC BREAKDOWN**1. Ethics and Human Interface****Theme Breakdown:**

1. **Essence of Ethics** – Meaning, nature, evolution of ethical thought.
2. **Determinants of Ethics** – Intention, means, end, motive, social norms, laws.
3. **Consequences of Ethics in Human Actions** – Moral consequences, utilitarianism, Kantian ethics.
4. **Dimensions of Ethics** – Individual, interpersonal, societal, global, professional.
5. **Ethics in Private Relationships** – Family, friendships, honesty, trust.
6. **Ethics in Public Relationships** – Workplace ethics, citizen-officer conduct, impartiality.
7. **Moral Relativism vs Universalism** – Cultural ethics vs global ethical standards.
8. **Ethics and Law Interface** – Legal compliance vs ethical responsibility.

2. Human Values**Theme Breakdown:**

1. **Meaning and Scope of Human Values** – Intrinsic vs instrumental values.
2. **Lessons from Great Leaders** – Gandhi (non-violence), Buddha (compassion), Vivekananda (selflessness).
3. **Lessons from Reformers** – Raja Ram Mohan Roy (social justice), Ambedkar (equality), Tagore (universalism).
4. **Lessons from Administrators** – Kiran Bedi (discipline), T.N. Seshan (integrity).
5. **Role of Family in Values** – Early moral imprinting, care, love.
6. **Role of Society** – Social approval, peer influence, collective norms.
7. **Role of Educational Institutions** – Curriculum, role models, value education.
8. **Value Conflicts** – Between individual and societal values.

3. Attitude**Theme Breakdown:**

1. **Content of Attitude** – Beliefs, feelings, behavioral intentions.

2. **Structure of Attitude** – ABC model (Affective, Behavioral, Cognitive).
3. **Functions of Attitude** – Adjustment, value-expressive, ego-defensive.
4. **Formation of Attitude** – Conditioning, modeling, social learning.
5. **Attitude-Behavior Link** – Theory of planned behavior, dissonance.
6. **Moral Attitude** – Ethical orientation, moral reasoning.
7. **Political Attitude** – Ideology, nationalism, tolerance.
8. **Social Influence & Persuasion** – Conformity, obedience, propaganda.

4. Aptitude and Foundational Values for Civil Services**Theme Breakdown:**

1. **Meaning of Aptitude** – Natural ability + learning.
2. **Integrity** – Consistency in thought and action.
3. **Impartiality and Non-partisanship** – Neutral decision-making.
4. **Objectivity** – Evidence-based approach.
5. **Dedication to Public Service** – Selflessness, duty.
6. **Empathy** – Understanding others' emotions.
7. **Tolerance** – Respect for diversity.
8. **Compassion** – Proactive helping, kindness.

5. Emotional Intelligence (EI)**Theme Breakdown:**

1. **Definition and Models** – Goleman's model, Mayer-Salovey model.
2. **Self-awareness** – Understanding own emotions.
3. **Self-regulation** – Managing impulses.
4. **Motivation** – Inner drive and resilience.
5. **Empathy** – Reading others' feelings accurately.
6. **Social Skills** – Conflict resolution, cooperation.
7. **Application in Administration** – Decision-making, leadership, teamwork.
8. **Training and Development** – Building EI in public servants.

6. Contributions of Moral Thinkers**Theme Breakdown:**

1. **Indian Moral Thinkers** – Gandhi, Vivekananda, Ambedkar, Buddha.
2. **Western Thinkers** – Aristotle, Kant, Bentham, Mill.
3. **Utilitarianism** – Greatest good principle.
4. **Deontological Ethics** – Duty-bound approach.
5. **Virtue Ethics** – Character-based morality.
6. **Ethics of Care** – Feminist perspective.
7. **Spiritual Ethics** – Dharma, Ahimsa, Nishkama Karma.
8. **Relevance in Governance** – Practical application in leadership.

7. Public/Civil Service Values and Ethics in Public**Administration****Theme Breakdown:**

1. **Values in Public Administration** – Integrity, neutrality, responsiveness.
2. **Status of Ethics in Governance** – Current challenges, trust deficit.
3. **Ethical Concerns in Govt & Pvt Institutions** – Conflicts of interest, lobbying.
4. **Sources of Ethical Guidance** – Laws, conscience, social norms.

5. **Accountability Mechanisms** – RTI, audits, vigilance bodies.
6. **Ethical Dilemmas** – Red tape vs discretion, loyalty vs truth.
7. **Corporate Governance** – CSR, transparency, stakeholder ethics.
8. **Ethics in International Relations** – Foreign aid, diplomacy, trade ethics.

8. Probity in Governance**Theme Breakdown:**

1. **Concept of Public Service** – Service motive, sacrifice.
2. **Philosophical Basis of Probity** – Truth, justice, trust.
3. **Information Sharing & Transparency** – RTI, proactive disclosure.
4. **Codes of Ethics & Conduct** – DoPT guidelines, international best practices.
5. **Citizen's Charter** – Time-bound service delivery.
6. **Work Culture** – Professionalism, discipline.
7. **Utilization of Public Funds** – Budget ethics, leakages.
8. **Corruption Challenges** – Prevention, detection, punishment.

Theme 1: Ethics and Human Interface

1. Essence of Ethics

Quote:

"Ethics is doing the right thing, even when no one is watching."

Introduction:

Ethics is the architecture of inner conviction a silent force that transforms action into duty by aligning it with universal values like **justice, compassion, integrity, and self-restraint**, beyond external compulsion or law.

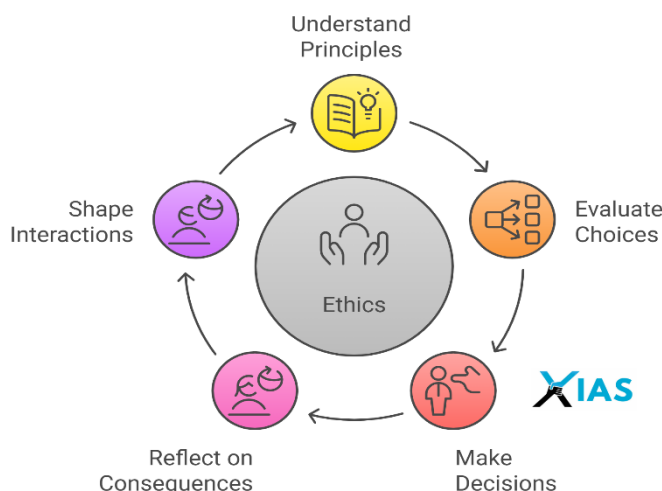
Examples:

- **IAS Armstrong Pame** built a 100-km road via crowdfunding, driven solely by **moral duty**.
- **ISRO scientists** work relentlessly, often beyond the call of duty, reflecting **silent ethical commitment**.
- **Sanitation workers during COVID-19** served amid personal risk without complaint or recognition.

Conclusion:

Ethics humanizes authority and anchors public behavior in **moral legitimacy**, ensuring that decisions are not just lawful but also **righteous**.

The Cycle of Ethical Behavior



2. Determinants of Ethics

Quote:

"A life of integrity is the most fundamental source of personal worth." – A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

Introduction:

Determinants of ethics are the inner and external factors—**intentions, motives, consequences, culture, upbringing, and reason**—that shape the **moral worth of human action**, especially in ethically conflicting situations.

Examples:

- **Lal Bahadur Shastri's resignation** after a train mishap showed **motive-led moral responsibility**.
- **Swachh Bharat Abhiyan** was launched with the ethical **intent to restore dignity** to sanitation work.
- **S. Manjunath**, IOCL officer, stood against **corruption** and sacrificed his life for **integrity**.

Conclusion:

Awareness of ethical determinants enables morally informed choices that uphold both **personal integrity** and **public interest**.

3. Consequences of Ethics in Human Actions

Quote:

"Ethics and equity and the principles of justice do not change with the calendar." – *Dr. B.R. Ambedkar*

Introduction:

Ethical actions produce not only immediate outcomes but also long-term societal ripples—strengthening **trust, institutions, and justice**, or conversely, eroding them if ethical principles are compromised.

Examples:

- **Durga Shakti Nagpal** upheld the law against illegal mining despite **political threats**.
- **India's Vaccine Maitri initiative** earned global **goodwill** through **value-driven diplomacy**.
- **SEBI's regulatory actions** enhanced **ethical practices in financial markets**.

Conclusion:

The **moral weight of action** is revealed in its **long-term impact**—building **trust, justice, and sustainable legitimacy**.

4. Dimensions of Ethics

Quote:

"Ethics is nothing but a sense of responsibility that extends beyond oneself." – *S. Radhakrishnan*

Introduction:

Ethics operates across **personal, interpersonal, societal, professional, and global domains**—each demanding consistent application of values, collectively shaping one's **moral reasoning and conduct** in diverse situations.

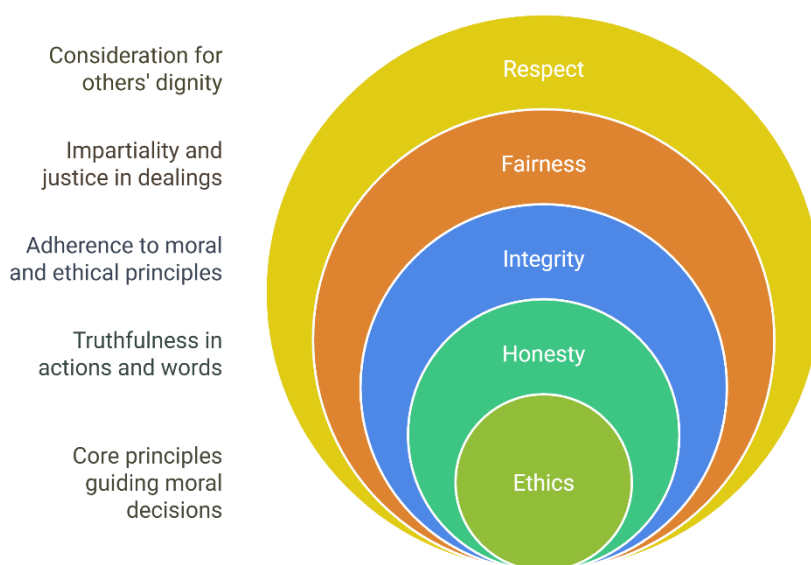
Examples:

- **Irom Sharmila's fast** reflected **personal ethics** against perceived state violence.
- **President Rajendra Prasad's neutrality** in office demonstrated **institutional ethics**.
- **India's global climate stance** reflects **ethical responsibility at the international level**.

Conclusion:

Ethical maturity lies in **harmonizing these dimensions**, ensuring that personal virtue and social duty coexist meaningfully.

Dimensions of Ethics



5. Ethics in Private Relationships

Quote:

“Values must be practiced first in the home, then in society.” – *Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam*

Introduction:

Private relationships are the training ground for moral values like **trust, empathy, loyalty, and responsibility**. These values later reflect in a person's public conduct and character.

Examples:

- **Gandhi's confession to his father** demonstrated **deep-rooted honesty and guilt** in personal relationships.
- **Sonu Sood's humanitarian work** was underpinned by **familial values and upbringing**.
- **PM Modi's devotion to his mother** highlights **humility and rooted ethics**.

Conclusion:

Private morality forms the core of public ethics—a strong personal value system strengthens larger social and institutional ethics.

6. Ethics in Public Relationships

Quote:

“Public service must be more than doing a job efficiently; it must be a complete dedication to the people.” – *Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel*

Introduction:

Ethics in public relationships demands fairness, transparency, impartiality, and responsiveness, ensuring that public servants act with **integrity and accountability** in the exercise of their duties.

Examples:

- **E. Sreedharan's leadership** in metro projects reflected **honesty and public dedication**.
- **S. R. Sankaran's service** to bonded labourers upheld **empathy in governance**.
- **COVID-19 frontline officials** risked personal safety, reflecting **duty-bound ethics**.

Conclusion:

Ethical public behavior fosters institutional trust, ensuring that governance remains **citizen-centric and morally accountable**.

7. Moral Relativism vs Universalism

Quote:

“Let us pick up our books and pens; they are our most powerful weapons.” – *Malala Yousafzai*

Introduction:

Moral relativism acknowledges the diversity of ethical norms, while **moral universalism upholds timeless values** like human dignity, justice, and equality as applicable across all cultures and contexts.

Examples:

- **Abolition of Sati** reflected **universal human rights over cultural practice**.
- **India's stand on gender rights at the UN** affirms **ethical universalism**.
- **Triple Talaq verdict** prioritized **universal gender justice over traditional custom**.

Conclusion:

Ethical balance lies in respecting culture while ensuring **universal moral principles are never compromised** in the name of tradition.

8. Ethics and Law Interface

Quote:

“Law and order are the medicine of the body politic and when the body politic gets sick, medicine must be administered.” – *Dr. B.R. Ambedkar*

Introduction:

Law provides the external boundaries of behavior, while **ethics governs the internal compass**. Ethics aspires for the ideal, often exceeding what the law requires, making both mutually reinforcing.

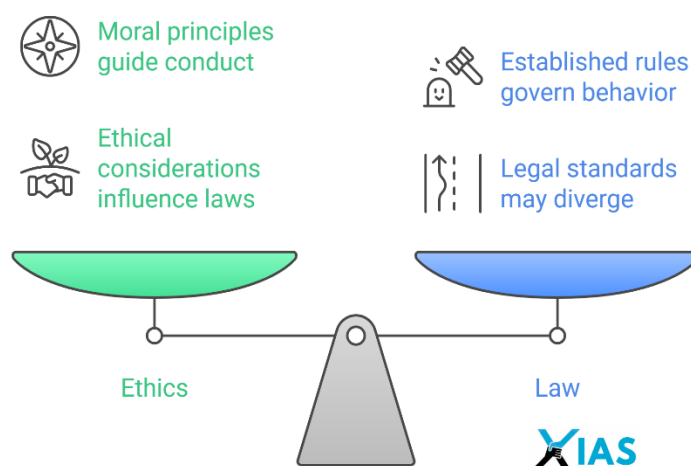
Examples:

- **Ashok Khemka's transfer history** shows **ethical resistance to legal misuse**.
- **Gandhi's Civil Disobedience** ethically challenged **legally valid but unjust laws**.
- **Judicial activism** often interprets **law through ethical reasoning** in PILs.

Conclusion:

Law without ethics is coercion, and **ethics without law is vulnerability**—together they ensure justice with conscience and accountability.

Balancing Ethics and Law in Society



Theme 2: Human Values

1. Meaning and Scope of Human Values

Quote:

"Where there is righteousness in the heart, there is beauty in the character." – *Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam*

Introduction:

Human values are the invisible architecture of human dignity and ethical purpose. They are intrinsic moral ideals that elevate behavior from **instinct to intention**, from **habit to humanity**—forming the ethical bedrock of civilization.

Examples:

- **Raja Ram Mohan Roy's reformist zeal** stemmed from the value of **human dignity**.
- **Gandhi's Satya and Ahimsa** defined the **spiritual core of non-violent struggle**.
- **NITI Aayog's Aspirational Districts Programme** promotes **equity and justice** for the most underserved.

Conclusion:

Human values cultivate the soul of a just society, ensuring that development is grounded in **compassion, fairness, and dignity for all**.

2. Lessons from Great Leaders

Quote:

"Be the change you wish to see in the world." – *Mahatma Gandhi*

Introduction:

The lives of great leaders are living texts of values in motion. Their leadership does not command through power, but persuades through virtue—showing how **character fused with courage** becomes a force for lasting change.

Examples:

- **Gandhi's Dandi March** embodied **truth and non-violent resistance**.
- **Dr. Kalam's humility** and scientific pursuit reflected **service over self**.
- **Nelson Mandela's forgiveness** after release demonstrated **restorative justice and healing**.

Conclusion:

Great leaders shape moral imagination, offering living examples of values applied under pressure—a compass for both citizens and statesmen.

3. Lessons from Reformers**Quote:**

"Educate, agitate, organize." – *Dr. B.R. Ambedkar*

Introduction:

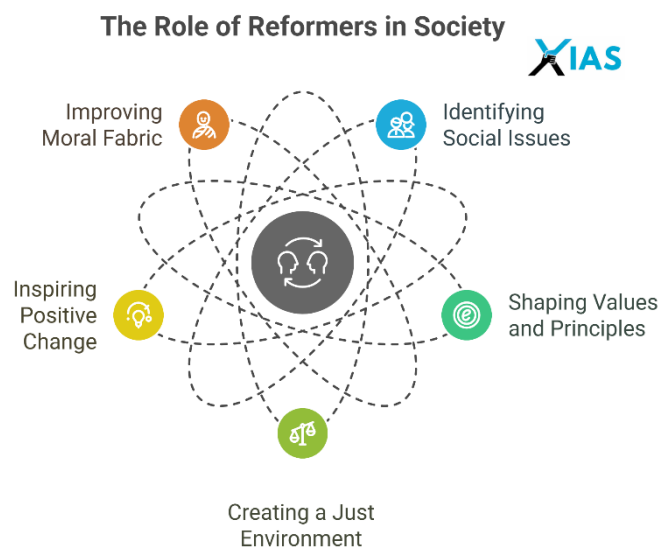
Reformers are moral engineers of society—they challenge entrenched injustice by rooting action in **universal values** like liberty, equality, and rationality, reorienting tradition through a moral and constitutional lens.

Examples:

- **Dr. Ambedkar's fight for Dalit rights** advanced **dignity and social justice**.
- **Raja Ram Mohan Roy's campaign against Sati** upheld **women's rights and reason**.
- **Vidyasagar's promotion of widow remarriage** reflected **compassion and gender equality**.

Conclusion:

Reformers inject ethics into history, turning personal conviction into **collective transformation through values-driven activism**.

**4. Lessons from Administrators****Quote:**

"A civil servant's greatest asset is the trust of the people." – *T.N. Seshan*

Introduction:

Ethical administrators are institutional conscience-keepers. They don't merely enforce rules but **embed values like fairness, empathy, and integrity into governance**, transforming policy into ethical public service.

Examples:

- T.N. Seshan's electoral reforms redefined **accountability and fearlessness** in public institutions.
- Kiran Bedi's prison reforms in Tihar were rooted in **dignity and rehabilitation**.
- IAS officer Pradeep Singh's work in Naxal areas shows **commitment to inclusive development**.

Conclusion:

Administrators driven by values build public trust, ensuring that governance upholds both **efficiency and ethical legitimacy**.

5. Role of Family in Inculcating Values

Quote:

"The family is the first school of social and moral learning." – *Jawaharlal Nehru*

Introduction:

Family is the crucible where the first moral impressions are forged. It teaches not by rules but by **example**, shaping a child's compass through **unspoken lessons in empathy, honesty, and discipline**.

Examples:

- **Gandhi's respect for truth** was instilled by his **mother's spiritual discipline**.
- **Dr. Kalam credited his father** for teaching him **honesty and austerity**.
- **Many civil servants attribute their service ethics** to **family role-modeling**.

Conclusion:

A value-rich family nurtures ethical citizens, laying the **foundation of public integrity in private morality**.

6. Role of Society in Inculcating Values

Quote:

"Society is the mirror where we refine our character." – *Dr. S. Radhakrishnan*

Introduction:

Society functions as a collective moral ecosystem, shaping ethics through **traditions, culture, peer behavior, and collective narratives**. It provides the stage where personal values are either **reinforced or resisted**.

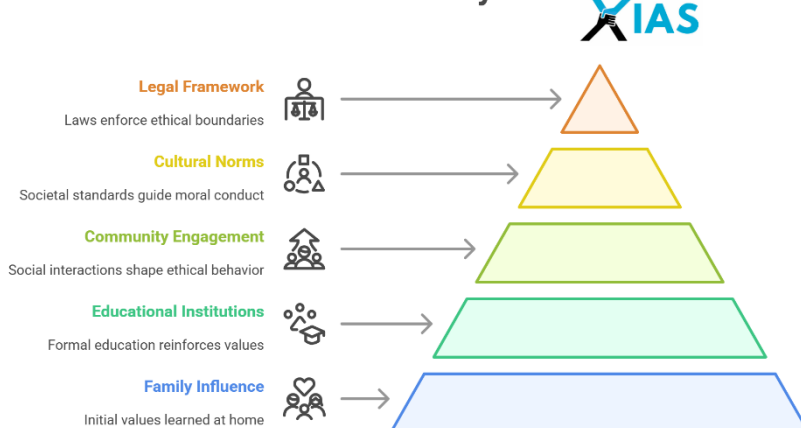
Examples:

- **Societal acceptance of LGBTQ+ rights** reflects growing **inclusivity and empathy**.
- **Narmada Bachao Andolan** built a movement on **environmental and indigenous values**.
- **COVID-19 community kitchens** showcased **solidarity and compassion**.

Conclusion:

A just society nurtures ethical reflexes, making moral action the norm not the exception across public and private life.

Societal Values Pyramid



7. Role of Educational Institutions in Inculcating Values

Quote:

“Education must build character before it builds careers.” – *Swami Vivekananda*

Introduction:

Educational institutions are nurseries of ethical citizenship, transforming intelligence into wisdom. Through curriculum, mentorship, and peer culture, they embed **empathy, service, and moral reasoning** in future generations.

Examples:

- **CBSE’s value education modules** promote **life skills, empathy, and ethics**.
- **TISS fosters ethical public engagement** through **field immersion and reflection**.
- **Navodaya Vidyalayas** instill **discipline, fraternity, and national integration**.

Conclusion:

Education rooted in values produces not just professionals, but public-spirited individuals who uplift society through both knowledge and character.

8. Value Conflicts in Public and Private Life

Quote:

“Your beliefs become your thoughts, your thoughts become your words... your destiny.” – *Mahatma Gandhi*

Introduction:

Value conflict is the ethical friction between personal beliefs and professional expectations. It tests **moral clarity, emotional courage, and ethical prioritization** when one must choose between conscience and convenience.

Examples:

- **An IAS officer exposing corruption** may face backlash from within the system.
- **Ratan Tata’s refusal to bribe** demonstrated value over profit.
- **Whistleblowers in corporate scams** uphold **public ethics over private loyalty**.

Conclusion:

Resolving value conflict demands principled balance, where the **ethical high ground is maintained** without forsaking role-responsibility or human dignity.

Theme 3: Attitude

1. Content of Attitude

Quote:

“Watch your thoughts, they become words... your destiny.” – *Mahatma Gandhi*

Introduction:

Attitude is a **structured mental orientation toward a person, object, or idea, shaped by beliefs, emotions, and behavioral intentions**. It forms the psychological filter through which individuals interpret and respond to the world.

Examples:

- A **positive attitude towards public service** motivated IAS officer **Arunraj K** to voluntarily teach underprivileged students.
- **Social media trolling** often stems from **negative attitudes formed by bias and misinformation**.
- **Swachh Bharat campaign** targeted public attitude change towards cleanliness, not just infrastructure.

Conclusion:

Understanding attitude content helps shape constructive behavior, fostering rational thinking, empathy, and proactive public engagement.

2. Structure of Attitude

Quote:

“What we think, we become.” – *Gautama Buddha*

Introduction:

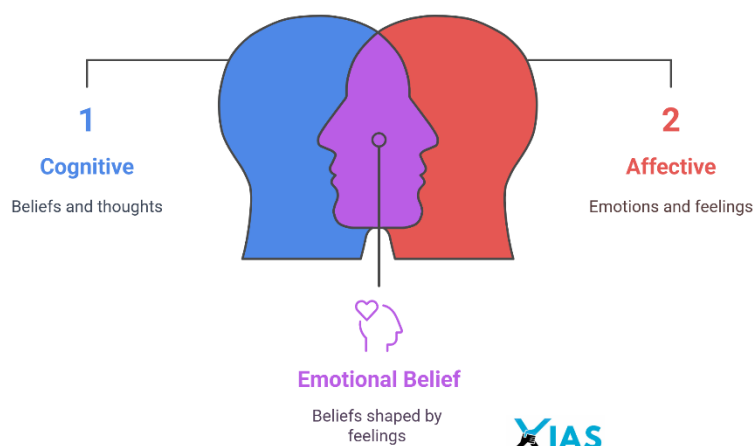
Attitude has a tripartite structure—cognitive (belief), affective (feeling), and behavioral (intention). These components interact to form a consistent psychological disposition, shaping how individuals evaluate and respond to stimuli.

Examples:

- **Gender bias** in hiring often stems from **cognitive stereotypes, emotional discomfort, and discriminatory behavior.**
- **Clean Ganga Mission** built on **belief in sacredness, emotional attachment, and volunteering actions.**
- **Public attitude toward disability** is evolving from sympathy to inclusion—across all three dimensions.

Conclusion:

Dissecting attitude structure enables targeted reforms, addressing not just what people think, but also how they feel and act.

The Interplay of Attitude Components**3. Functions of Attitude****Quote:**

"We are kept from our goal not by obstacles, but by a clear path to a lesser goal." – *Bhagavad Gita*

Introduction:

Attitudes serve key functions—adaptive, ego-defensive, value-expressive, and knowledge-based helping individuals navigate complex environments while maintaining **psychological stability and social identity.**

Examples:

- **Caste prejudices** serve **ego-defensive functions** to justify inherited privilege.
- **Patriotism in national service** performs a **value-expressive function**, as seen during disaster relief.
- **Voting choices** often reflect the **knowledge function**, simplifying political complexity.

Conclusion:

Recognizing attitude functions enables tailored policy interventions, transforming resistance into acceptance and apathy into participation.

4. Formation of Attitude**Quote:**

"You don't just live in a society; society lives in you." – *Dr. B.R. Ambedkar*

Introduction:

Attitudes are formed through socialization, experience, conditioning, role models, and media exposure. They evolve over time, influenced by family, culture, institutions, and life events.

Examples:

- **Stereotypes about manual labor** are often learned in childhood through **family and societal messaging**.
- **School campaigns promoting gender equality** shape **positive attitudes early**.
- **Media glorification of violence** can foster **aggressive or insensitive attitudes** in youth.

Conclusion:

Early and ethical attitude formation is critical to building citizens who are socially conscious and emotionally intelligent.

5. Attitude-Behaviour Relationship**Quote:**

"Action is the real measure of intelligence." – *Napoleon Hill*

Introduction:

While attitudes influence behavior, the relationship is moderated by factors like social pressure, opportunity, and perceived consequences. Alignment of belief and action defines authenticity and ethical consistency.

Examples:

- A civil servant may value **honesty** but **remain silent in corruption** due to fear or peer pressure.
- **RTI activists act on attitudes of transparency**, converting beliefs into action.
- **Plastic bans** often fail when attitudes are positive but behavior remains unchanged due to inconvenience.

Conclusion:

Bridging the attitude-behavior gap requires not just awareness but supportive environments, courage, and value reinforcement.

6. Moral and Political Attitudes**Quote:**

"Politics without principles is a sin." – *Mahatma Gandhi*

Introduction:

Moral attitude reflects an individual's internalized sense of right and wrong, while political attitude expresses views on power, authority, and governance. Together, they shape civic conduct and public reasoning.

Examples:

- **Moral attitude led whistleblowers like Manjunath and Satyendra Dubey** to act against corruption.
- **Youth participation in elections** reflects evolving **political attitudes of empowerment**.
- **Polarized media** can distort both **moral clarity and political tolerance**.

Conclusion:

Balanced moral and political attitudes are vital to nurture participative democracy and ethical governance.

7. Social Influence**Quote:**

"A man is but the product of his thoughts and the environment he lives in." – *Mahatma Gandhi*

Introduction:

Social influence refers to how individuals' attitudes and behaviors are shaped by others through conformity, obedience, persuasion, or peer pressure. It can lead to both constructive and destructive choices.

Examples:

- **Bystander effect** in public emergencies shows how **conformity dampens moral action**.
- **Youth volunteering inspired by peers** in NSS or NCC is **positive social influence**.
- **Mass disinformation on social media** creates **herd mentality** and reactive attitudes.

Conclusion:

Understanding social influence helps guard autonomy, enabling individuals to act with conviction, not conformity.

8. Persuasion**Quote:**

“You can change people’s minds by touching their hearts.” – *Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam*

Introduction:

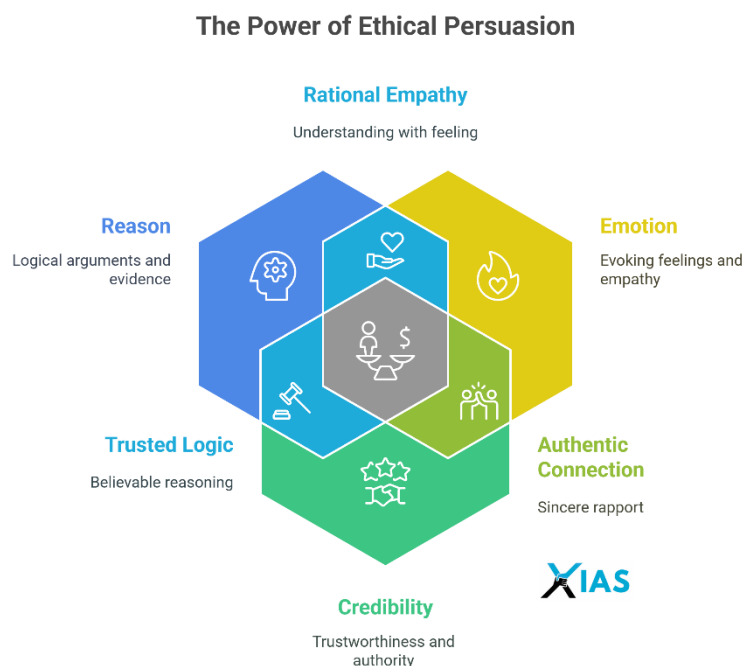
Persuasion is the ethical art of changing attitudes through reason, emotion, and credibility. It is central to public communication, behavior change, and leadership in democratic societies.

Examples:

- **IEC campaigns in Swachh Bharat** used **emotive and logical appeal** to shift mindsets.
- **Gandhi’s speeches** persuaded masses using **moral authority over rhetoric**.
- **Nudging through policy design** (e.g., UPI adoption) used **soft persuasion over compulsion**.

Conclusion:

Effective persuasion respects autonomy while inspiring transformation, making it a cornerstone of ethical governance and citizen engagement.

**Theme 4: Aptitude and Foundational Values for Civil Services****1. Aptitude – Meaning and Relevance****Quote:**

“Excellence happens not by accident. It is a process.” – *Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam*

Introduction:

Aptitude is the innate or acquired ability to understand, act, and adapt effectively in specific contexts. It reflects **mental sharpness, emotional regulation, and ethical clarity**, making it foundational for sound public decision-making.

Examples:

- **IAS topper Pradeep Singh’s consistent preparation** reflected both **analytical aptitude and emotional discipline**.

- District collectors managing disaster zones combine crisis aptitude with empathetic field leadership.
- Aptitude tests in UPSC exams assess problem-solving, comprehension, and judgment under pressure.

Conclusion:

Aptitude ensures efficiency with integrity, enabling civil servants to respond with competence, sensitivity, and ethical balance in dynamic governance settings.

2. Integrity

Quote:

“It is easy to stand with the crowd. It takes courage to stand alone.” – Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

Introduction:

Integrity is the unwavering consistency between one’s values, words, and actions—even in the absence of external scrutiny. It is the ethical anchor of public trust and the hallmark of true character.

Examples:

- S. Manjunath and Satyendra Dubey, both martyred while upholding professional integrity.
- Ashok Khemka’s repeated transfers reflect his stand against systemic malpractice.
- T.N. Seshan’s fearless election reforms were driven by a non-negotiable integrity of purpose.

Conclusion:

Integrity transforms authority into trust, ensuring that governance is not only lawful, but also morally credible.

3. Impartiality and Non-partisanship

Quote:

“A public servant belongs to the people, not to a party.” – Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

Introduction:

Impartiality is the ability to decide without prejudice or personal bias, while **non-partisanship** means maintaining distance from political influence.

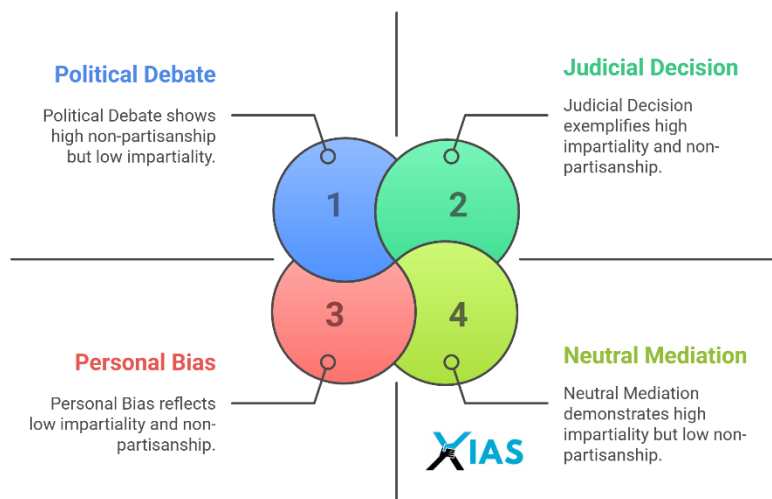
Examples:

- Election Commission officers during polls exemplify non-partisan duty over political pressure.
- Supreme Court rulings often reinforce institutional impartiality in sensitive cases.
- Whistleblowing in politically connected scams reflects ethical courage above party lines.

Conclusion:

Impartiality and non-partisanship uphold the Constitution above convenience, ensuring justice is served without fear, favor, or faction.

Impartiality and Non-partisanship in Decision-Making



4. Objectivity

Quote:

"Facts are sacred; opinion is free." – *Jawaharlal Nehru*

Introduction:

Objectivity is the ability to make decisions based on evidence, logic, and fairness rather than emotions, bias, or external pressures. It is essential for equitable governance and rational public service delivery.

Examples:

- **Right to Information (RTI)** institutionalized **evidence-based decision-making**.
- **UPSC interview panels** are designed to be **objective and neutral**.
- **E-governance tools like JAM trinity** reduce **subjectivity in welfare distribution**.

Conclusion:

Objectivity ensures that fairness prevails over favoritism, building credibility and predictability in public institutions.

5. Dedication to Public Service

Quote:

"The best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others." – *Mahatma Gandhi*

Introduction:

Dedication to public service is a value that prioritizes collective welfare over personal gain. It transforms duty into devotion, and office into an instrument of justice and compassion.

Examples:

- **IAS Armstrong Pame's road-building mission** in Manipur showed **selfless administrative commitment**.
- **Healthcare workers during COVID-19** exemplified **sacrifice for public well-being**.
- **Civil servants working in LWE regions** show **unwavering service under risk**.

Conclusion:

Dedication fuels ethical resilience, making civil servants true agents of inclusive and responsive governance.

6. Empathy

Quote:

"Leadership is not about being in charge. It is about taking care of those in your charge." – *Narendra Modi*

Introduction:

Empathy is the ability to perceive and internalize others' emotions, experiences, and struggles. It bridges the gap between **policy intent and lived realities**, especially for the vulnerable.

Examples:

- **IAS officer Rohini Sindhuri's work for manual scavengers** reflected **deep human empathy**.
- **District-level helplines for migrant workers during lockdowns** were rooted in **empathetic governance**.
- **PM's 'Mann Ki Baat'** often highlights stories that evoke **public emotional connect**.

Conclusion:

Empathy creates emotionally intelligent leadership, ensuring that the state does not act as a machine, but as a moral organism.

7. Tolerance

Quote:

"Tolerance and patience are much stronger than brute force." – *Subhas Chandra Bose*

Introduction:

Tolerance is the willingness to accept views, behaviors, or beliefs different from one's own. It reflects **maturity in pluralism**, and is vital for harmony in a diverse, democratic society.

Examples:

- **India's constitutional protection of religious and linguistic minorities** is rooted in **tolerance**.

- **Civil society protests** (e.g., Anna Hazare Movement) were largely respected in a **tolerant democratic framework**.
- **Public officials dealing with aggressive stakeholders** often practice **patience and restraint**.

Conclusion:

Tolerance builds bridges in conflict, making peaceful coexistence and inclusive progress not just possible, but sustainable.

8. Compassion toward the Weaker Sections

Quote:

"A nation's greatness is measured by how it treats its weakest members." – *Mahatma Gandhi*

Introduction:

Compassion is not charity it is moral responsiveness. It is the inner call to **uplift the vulnerable with dignity**, and ensure that governance does not neglect those most in need of care and protection.

Examples:

- **PM Garib Kalyan Yojana** offered urgent support to the poor during the pandemic.
- **Mission Antyodaya and DAY-NRLM** reflect **compassion-driven development models**.
- **IAS officers working with tribal communities** promote **culturally sensitive and inclusive administration**.

Conclusion:

Compassion ensures that justice reaches the last citizen, transforming welfare from a policy to a promise fulfilled with empathy.

Theme 5: Emotional Intelligence

1. Definition and Relevance of Emotional Intelligence

Quote:

"To handle yourself, use your head; to handle others, use your heart." – *Jawaharlal Nehru*

Introduction:

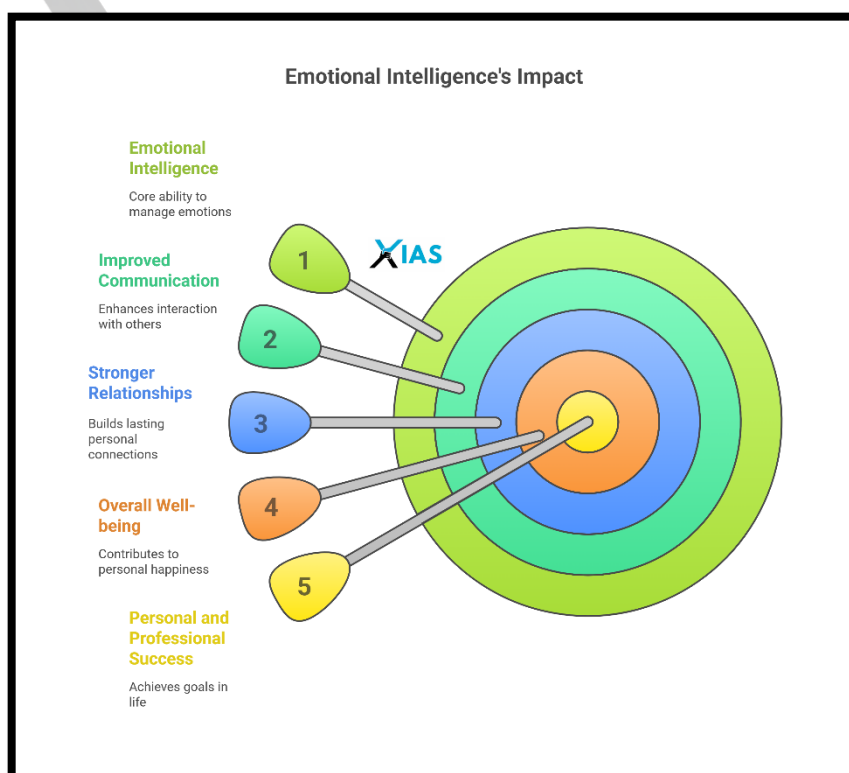
Emotional Intelligence is the integration of emotional awareness and cognitive regulation, enabling individuals to **understand, manage, and apply emotions** effectively for ethical judgment, adaptive behavior, and constructive human interaction.

Examples:

- **IAS officers during COVID-19** responded with empathy to public panic.
- **Chandrayaan-3 team** managed emotional highs and lows with composure.
- **Police handling farmers' protests** relied on emotional balance over force.

Conclusion:

Emotional intelligence creates emotionally stable institutions, where empathy and ethics inform governance beyond rigid procedures.



2. Self-awareness

Quote:

"The first step in solving a problem is to recognize your role in creating it." – Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

Introduction:

Self-awareness is the capacity to introspectively access one's emotional states, values, and impulses, forming the basis for **emotional self-regulation, authenticity, and ethical alignment** in personal and administrative contexts.

Examples:

- **Dr. Kalam's humility** stemmed from conscious self-understanding.
- **Ira Singhal's resolve** reflected clarity of purpose and emotional identity.
- **LBSNAA's feedback exercises** promote introspection and ethical grounding.

Conclusion:

Self-awareness cultivates moral clarity, enabling public servants to lead with inner balance and transparent intentions.

3. Self-regulation

Quote:

"Calmness is the cradle of power." – Jawaharlal Nehru

Introduction:

Self-regulation is the internal capacity to manage emotions, delay impulses, and maintain equilibrium, especially under stress, enabling **measured, ethical, and policy-aligned responses** in public life.

Examples:

- **IPS officers during violent protests** acted with restraint despite provocation.
- **Judges avoid reaction to public pressure**, maintaining courtroom neutrality.
- **Civil servants under political heat** choose silence over reactive statements.

Conclusion:

Self-regulation stabilizes public authority, ensuring dignity, legality, and maturity in emotionally charged situations.

4. Motivation

Quote:

"Dreams are not what you see in sleep; dreams are those that do not let you sleep." – Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

Introduction:

Motivation in emotional intelligence refers to the inner emotional drive toward meaningful goals, sustained by purpose, resilience, and moral conviction, beyond external rewards.

Examples:

- **Kiran Bedi's prison reforms** emerged from inner ethical passion.
- **ISRO scientists' perseverance** reflects long-term goal commitment.
- **Officers in remote tribal areas** work under extreme hardship with inner dedication.

Conclusion:

Motivated public servants convert vision into action, sustaining reforms even in adversity or institutional inertia.



5. Empathy

Quote:

"The best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others." – *Mahatma Gandhi*

Introduction:

Empathy is the cognitive-emotional ability to vicariously understand others' emotions, enabling **inclusive, sensitive, and dignity-driven governance** rooted in lived human realities.

Examples:

- **Rohini Sindhuri's support for manual scavengers** reflected empathetic intervention.
- **COVID migrant camps** responded to the emotional distress of the displaced.
- **Disability-inclusive designs in administration** reflect institutional empathy.

Conclusion:

Empathy brings humanity into statecraft, transforming delivery into dignity-based service.

6. Social Skills

Quote:

"The art of communication is the language of leadership." – *Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam*

Introduction:

Social skills encompass emotionally intelligent behaviors like communication, collaboration, and conflict resolution, essential for **trust-building, participatory governance, and effective team functioning** in administration.

Examples:

- **Disaster response teams** work through inter-agency coordination and clarity.
- **Gram Sabha engagement** relies on communication and persuasion.
- **Mann Ki Baat** demonstrates emotional resonance in political outreach.

Conclusion:

Social skills make governance accessible and participatory, fostering collaboration between state and citizen.

7. Application of EI in Administration

Quote:

"Man becomes great exactly in the degree in which he works for the welfare of his fellow men." – *Mahatma Gandhi*

Introduction:

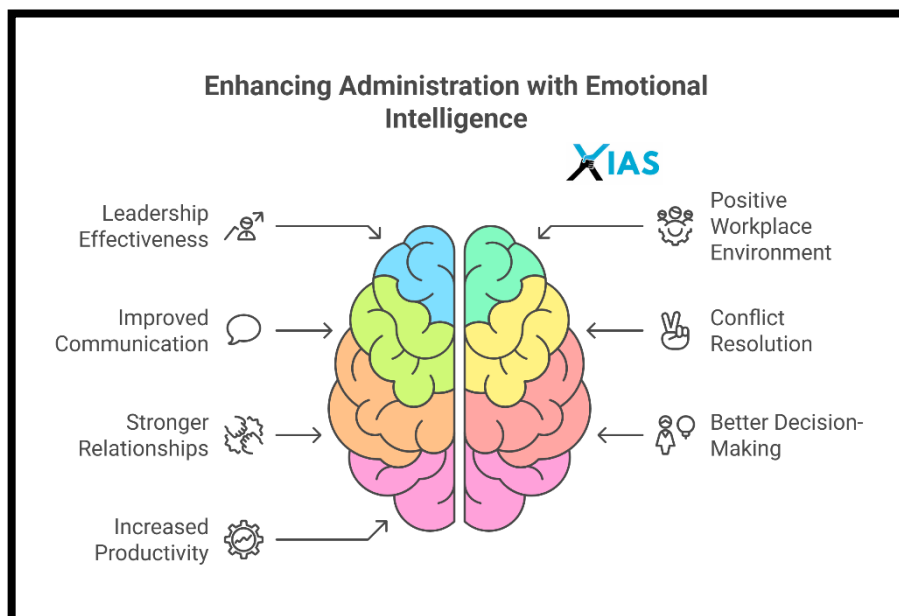
Application of emotional intelligence in administration involves using emotional insight to manage people, defuse tensions, and resolve conflicts, with **ethical composure and social awareness**.

Examples:

- **Collectors using dialogue over force in protests** show EI in crisis.
- **Juvenile justice boards** prefer emotional restoration over punishment.
- **Public grievance cells** demand calm, tactful engagement.

Conclusion:

EI enhances the emotional architecture of governance, where decisions are humane, not just procedural.



8. Building EI in Civil Services

Quote:

“Character is the foundation upon which leadership is built.” – *Dr. S. Radhakrishnan*

Introduction:

Building EI in civil services involves structured cultivation of emotional competencies self-awareness, empathy, and social sensitivity through **training, feedback, and experiential learning**.

Examples:

- **LBSNAA uses role-play, feedback, and mindfulness modules.**
- **360-degree reviews** build self-insight in leadership roles.
- **Peer learning during Bharat Darshan** builds empathy and cultural sensitivity.

Conclusion:

Emotionally intelligent civil servants uphold ethics with compassion, enriching both policy and people with value-based conduct

Theme - 6. Contributions of Moral Thinkers

1. Contributions of Mahatma Gandhi

Quote:

“In matters of conscience, the law of the majority has no place.” – *Mahatma Gandhi*

Introduction:

Gandhi's moral philosophy was a fusion of ethical absolutism and spiritual activism, where **truth (Satya)** and **non-violence (Ahimsa)** were not just ideals but actionable instruments of civil resistance and human dignity.

Examples:

- **Salt March** exemplified **ethical protest over violent agitation**.
- **Trusteeship theory** encouraged **compassionate capitalism**.
- **His influence on civil rights movements** gave **global ethical resonance** to Indian values.

Conclusion:

Gandhi transformed morality into mass action, making values the core force of national and global transformation.

2. Contributions of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar

Quote:

“I measure the progress of a community by the degree of progress which women have achieved.” – *Dr. B.R. Ambedkar*

Introduction:

Ambedkar's moral vision was rooted in the dismantling of inherited hierarchies through rationality, equality, and constitutional ethics, making **dignity and justice non-negotiable principles of public morality**.

Examples:

- **Hindu Code Bill** advanced **gender justice**.
- **Drafting the Constitution** embedded **social morality into legal order**.
- **Conversion to Buddhism** rejected caste as **morally illegitimate**.

Conclusion:

Ambedkar moralized modernity, ensuring the Indian state's ethical architecture rests on liberty, justice, and equality.

3. Contributions of Swami Vivekananda

Quote:

“They alone live who live for others.” – *Swami Vivekananda*

Introduction:

Vivekananda's moral philosophy blended Vedantic spirituality with social uplift, where **service, strength, and self-mastery** became tools for both national regeneration and ethical self-realization.

Examples:

- **Ramakrishna Mission** embodies his **"service as worship"** doctrine.
- His **Chicago address** stressed **unity beyond religion**.
- **Youth empowerment campaigns** draw on his vision of **inner character over outer achievement**.

Conclusion:

Vivekananda awakened India's moral confidence, making ethics an instrument of national and individual excellence.

4. Contributions of Rabindranath Tagore**Quote:**

"The highest education is that which does not merely give us information but makes our life in harmony with all existence." – *Rabindranath Tagore*

Introduction:

Tagore's ethics was rooted in aesthetic humanism, where **freedom, creativity, and universal compassion** merged into a moral vision beyond borders, religions, or narrow nationalisms.

Examples:

- **Santiniketan** fostered **value-based creative education**.
- **Critique of hyper-nationalism** reflected his **ethical universalism**.
- **Gitanjali's poetic morality** blends **individual conscience with cosmic empathy**.

Conclusion:

Tagore gave Indian ethics a global voice, rooted in beauty, freedom, and emotional universality.

Tagore's Ethical Contributions

**Philosophical Insights**

Tagore's deep philosophical thoughts on ethics

Literary Works

Ethical themes explored in Tagore's writings

Educational Reforms

Tagore's innovative approaches to ethical education

Social Activism

Tagore's efforts to promote ethical social change

5. Contributions of Gautama Buddha

Quote:

"Hatred does not cease by hatred, but only by love—this is the eternal rule." – *Gautama Buddha*

Introduction:

Buddha's moral thought was psychological, experiential, and pragmatic, centering on **suffering, mindfulness, and ethical causality**, where morality emerged not from divine command, but from awareness and right action.

Examples:

- **Eightfold Path** prescribes **ethical living through mindfulness**.
- **Ashoka's Dhamma** turned Buddhist ethics into **state policy**.
- **Vipassana in Indian prisons** uses his method for **inner moral reform**.

Conclusion:

Buddha offered a self-cultivated ethics, where transformation begins within and radiates into society.

6. Contributions of Immanuel Kant

Quote:

"Act only on that maxim which you can will to become a universal law." – *Immanuel Kant*

Introduction:

Kant's deontological ethics located morality in rational autonomy, where ethical actions stem not from outcomes, but from **duty governed by reason and universalizability**.

Examples:

- **Whistleblowers like Satyendra Dubey** acted from **duty, not utility**.
- **Rule-following in public institutions** echoes **Kant's respect for moral law**.
- **Right to dignity** in constitutional law reflects **Kantian influence**.

Conclusion:

Kant's rational ethics safeguards dignity, making law a servant of reason and conscience.

7. Contributions of Aristotle

Quote:

"Moral excellence is not an act, but a habit." – *Aristotle*

Introduction:

Aristotle's virtue ethics focused on character formation through habituated excellence, where the '**Golden Mean**' guided moral action between deficiency and excess in real-life contexts.

Examples:

- **Civil servant neutrality** balances **courage with caution**.
- **Honesty practiced with discretion** reflects **virtue in equilibrium**.
- **Ethics training in services** aims to build **moral habit, not just knowledge**.

Conclusion:

Aristotle turned ethics into a lived craft, making moral maturity a matter of trained disposition.

8. Contributions of John Stuart Mill

Quote:

"A person may cause evil to others not only by his actions but by his inaction." – *J.S. Mill*

Introduction:

Mill's utilitarianism anchored morality in consequences, where ethical action aims to **maximize happiness and minimize harm**, while safeguarding individual liberty through his famous '**harm principle**'.

Examples:

- **Public health campaigns** follow **greatest-good logic**.
- **Free speech jurisprudence** draws on **Mill's liberty ethics**.

- Welfare schemes weigh cost-benefit ethical calculus.

Conclusion:

Mill made utility ethically respectable, bridging liberal freedoms with collective welfare in modern governance.

Theme 7: Public/Civil Service Values and Ethics in Public Administration

1. Values in Public Administration

Quote:

“The end of all education, all training, should be man-making.” – Swami Vivekananda

Introduction:

Public service values are abstract ethical benchmarks that transform bureaucratic power into moral authority, guiding officials to act with **duty, fairness, empathy, and institutional loyalty** in complex governance environments.

Examples:

- T.N. Seshan’s electoral reforms embodied **integrity and fearlessness**.
- E. Sreedharan’s leadership in Delhi Metro reflected **excellence and punctuality**.
- Mission Karmayogi focuses on **value-based bureaucratic capacity building**.

Conclusion:

Values are the ethical compass of administration, ensuring that efficiency does not outpace accountability and authority remains anchored in legitimacy.

2. Status of Ethics in Governance

Quote:

“A person who is morally educated will be a lot better equipped to move up the ladder of life.” – Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

Introduction:

The status of ethics in governance reflects how deeply moral reasoning like justice, transparency, and restraint—has permeated administrative behavior, political culture, and institutional decision-making.

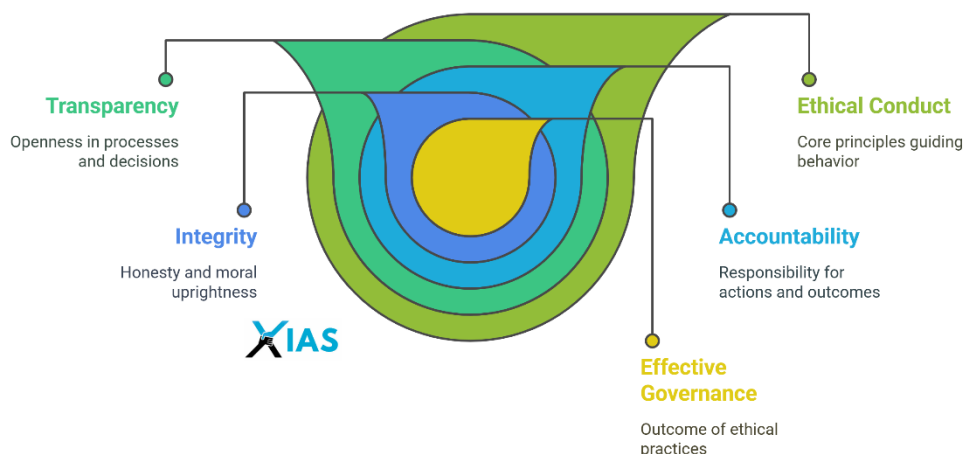
Examples:

- Frequent high-level scams indicate **ethical vulnerability** in governance.
- RTI Act and Lokpal show attempts at **restoring institutional morality**.
- Whistleblowing in Vyapam and coal block cases reflect ethical assertion from within.

Conclusion:

A government is only as ethical as its daily conduct, not merely its constitutional promises or public declarations.

Ethics in Governance



3. Ethical Concerns in Government and Private Institutions

Quote:

"The line between right and wrong is often drawn by self-interest." – *Nani Palkhivala*

Introduction:

Ethical concerns emerge when institutional conduct diverges from normative standards of responsibility, resulting in abuse of power, conflict of interest, and erosion of public or stakeholder trust.

Examples:

- Banking scandals (e.g., PMC, Yes Bank) exposed regulatory negligence and greed.
- Nirav Modi case showed weak ethical oversight in public banking.
- Corporate greenwashing misrepresents ethical responsibility as image-building.

Conclusion:

Institutional ethics cannot depend on compliance alone; it must be grounded in moral culture and individual accountability.

4. Sources of Ethical Guidance

Quote:

"Law is only a floor; morality is the ceiling." – *Dr. B.R. Ambedkar*

Introduction:

Ethical guidance originates from a blend of codified rules, constitutional ideals, social norms, and inner conscience, offering both external direction and internal restraint in decision-making under ambiguity.

Examples:

- All India Services Conduct Rules formalize ethical standards.
- Judicial references to constitutional morality surpass mere legality.
- Grassroots movements like RTI reflect public moral expectations.

Conclusion:

Sustainable ethics emerge when law, role, and inner conscience converge to guide action under uncertainty.

5. Accountability and Ethical Governance

Quote:

"Power must always be accompanied by responsibility." – *Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru*

Introduction:

Accountability is the moral architecture of governance, ensuring that authority is exercised under scrutiny, answerability, and consequence—thereby aligning public power with ethical performance.

Examples:

- RTI ensures administrative transparency to citizens.
- CAG reports expose misuse of public funds.
- Social audits in MGNREGA allow community-level accountability.

Conclusion:

Accountability institutionalizes humility in governance, transforming power from privilege to public stewardship.

6. Strengthening Ethical and Moral Values in Governance

Quote:

"Morality cannot be legislated, but behavior can be regulated." – *Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.*

Introduction:

Strengthening values in governance involves institutionalizing virtues such as integrity, compassion, and impartiality through systemic reform, ethical leadership, and norm-setting public behavior.

Examples:

- Mission Karmayogi introduces ethics modules in training.

- Ethics audits in government bodies review moral climate.
- Role models like Vinod Rai inspire ethical emulation.

Conclusion:

Ethics in governance must be cultivated like a habit, not enforced like a rule.

7. Ethical Issues in International Relations and Funding

Quote:

“A just world order must be rooted in values, not just power.” – Atal Bihari Vajpayee

Introduction:

Ethics in international relations involves reconciling national interest with global justice, where foreign aid, diplomacy, and negotiations are filtered through principles of fairness, sovereignty, and human dignity.

Examples:

- India’s Vaccine Maitri showed compassion-driven diplomacy.
- Debate over IMF loan conditions raises ethics of debt and sovereignty.
- India’s stance on Russia–Ukraine war balanced neutrality with humanitarian concerns.

Conclusion:

Ethical diplomacy earns global trust, especially when morality aligns with strategic clarity.



8. Corporate Governance and Ethics

Quote:

“Profit in business comes from repeat customers, customers that boast about your product or service.” – J.R.D. Tata

Introduction:

Corporate ethics refers to the moral framework that governs business conduct, demanding transparency, accountability, and stakeholder equity beyond mere legal compliance or shareholder gain.

Examples:

- **Tata Group's ethical legacy** promotes **values alongside value creation**.
- **Infosys whistleblower case** highlighted internal ethical vigilance.
- **CSR mandates under Companies Act** formalized business social responsibility.

Conclusion:

Ethical corporates build not just markets but moral ecosystems, where growth includes governance and conscience.

Theme 8: Probity in Governance**1. Concept of Public Service****Quote:**

"Public service must be more than doing a job efficiently and honestly. It must be a complete dedication to the people." – *Margaret Chase Smith*

Introduction:

The concept of public service refers to the ethical obligation of using state authority for collective welfare, grounded in **duty, neutrality, compassion, and responsible stewardship of public trust**.

Examples:

- **Lal Bahadur Shastri's resignation after a train accident** exemplified **moral accountability**.
- **Ashok Khemka's frequent transfers** reflect **unwavering dedication to integrity**.
- **Civil servants in aspirational districts** work with **mission-mode selflessness**.

Conclusion:

Public service transforms office into obligation, where power becomes a moral commitment to uplift the weakest without bias or fear.

2. Philosophical Basis of Governance and Probity**Quote:**

"A man of character will make himself worthy of any position he is given." – *Mahatma Gandhi*

Introduction:

Probity is the philosophical expression of moral uprightness in public life, where **virtue, truth, and transparency** converge to ensure that governance is not just lawful but ethically legitimate.

Examples:

- **Kautilya in Arthashastra** emphasized **ethical conduct of rajadharma (king's duty)**.
- **Sardar Patel's emphasis on impartial civil services** reflected **value-centric governance**.
- **Anti-corruption laws** institutionalize **ethical behavior as a normative expectation**.

Conclusion:

Governance without probity breeds legalism without legitimacy, where compliance exists but conscience collapses.

3. Information Sharing and Transparency in Government**Quote:**

"Information is the currency of democracy." – *Thomas Jefferson*

Introduction:

Transparency in governance is the proactive disclosure of institutional processes, decisions, and performance, allowing public scrutiny and trust through **openness, visibility, and participative accountability**.

Examples:

- **RTI Act empowered citizens** with access to decision-making.
- **Digital dashboards (e.g., PM Gati Shakti)** improve **real-time transparency**.
- **e-Samiksha portal** monitors government work with **inter-ministerial openness**.

Conclusion:

Transparency converts secrecy into service, ensuring that state power operates under the light of public awareness.

4. Right to Information (RTI)**Quote:**

“When the people are well informed, they can be trusted with their own government.” – *Thomas Jefferson*

Introduction:

The Right to Information is a legal and ethical tool that transforms passive subjects into active citizens, empowering them to question, audit, and engage with the machinery of governance.

Examples:

- **RTI exposed the Adarsh housing scam and many recruitment irregularities.**
- **Public Distribution System leakages** were revealed via **RTI filings**.
- **Whistleblowers like RTI activist Amit Jethwa laid bare environmental violations.**

Conclusion:

RTI institutionalizes democratic ethics, turning governance from a monologue into a monitored dialogue.

5. Codes of Ethics and Codes of Conduct**Quote:**

“Ethics is knowing the difference between what you have a right to do and what is right to do.” – *Potter Stewart*

Introduction:

Codes of Ethics provide aspirational moral standards, while Codes of Conduct lay down enforceable behavioral rules, together creating an ethical infrastructure for professional accountability in public service.

Examples:

- **All India Services Conduct Rules (1968)** prescribe **civil servant behavior**.
- **Model Code of Conduct during elections** ensures **fairness and neutrality**.
- **Many PSUs follow internal Codes of Ethics for conflict management.**

Conclusion:

Ethical codes translate values into action, ensuring clarity, consistency, and institutional conscience in public functionaries.

6. Citizen's Charters**Quote:**

“The true ruler is the one who serves his people best.” – *Chanakya*

Introduction:

Citizen's Charters are public declarations of service commitments, timelines, and grievance redressal, fostering transparency, accountability, and responsiveness in public service delivery.

Examples:

- **Passport Seva Kendras** operate under **defined service charters**.
- **Railways and hospitals** display **time-bound commitments for public services**.
- **E-Seva in Andhra Pradesh** incorporated **charters with real-time tracking**.

Conclusion:

Citizen's charters operationalize ethical governance, converting intent into accessible and time-bound delivery.

7. Work Culture**Quote:**

“Culture eats strategy for breakfast.” – *Peter Drucker*

Introduction:

Work culture in governance refers to the collective ethos, values, and behavioral norms that shape how public duties are performed, influencing **efficiency, accountability, and ethical climate** in institutions.

Examples:

- Kerala's decentralized planning is rooted in **collaborative and responsive work culture**.
- E. Sreedharan's Metro team reflected **professional punctuality**.
- Citizen feedback under SPARSH platform helps improve **attitudinal ethos**.

Conclusion:

Work culture is the silent ethic of governance, shaping daily performance more than rules ever can.

8. Quality of Service Delivery**Quote:**

"The customer is the most important visitor on our premises." – Mahatma Gandhi

Introduction:

Quality of service delivery in governance reflects how effectively, fairly, and empathetically public goods and services reach beneficiaries, measuring both **procedural efficiency** and **moral inclusiveness**.

Examples:

- Mohalla Clinics in Delhi deliver **accessible and timely health services**.
- Jan Dhan-Aadhaar-Mobile (JAM) trinity ensures **leakage-free benefit transfers**.
- One Nation One Ration Card enhances **delivery portability**.

Conclusion:

Service quality transforms citizens from **beneficiaries to stakeholders**, deepening both inclusion and trust.

Enhancing Governance through Service Delivery**9. Utilization of Public Funds****Quote:**

"Public money must be treated with the same sacredness as temple offerings." – Chanakya

Introduction:

Utilization of public funds involves **ethical allocation, spending, and monitoring of taxpayer resources**, ensuring **efficiency, equity, and integrity in financial stewardship**.

Examples:

- CAG audits reveal misuse in MPLADS and MNREGA.
- Direct Benefit Transfers reduce leakages in subsidies.
- PFMS platform tracks real-time fund flows.

Conclusion:

Fiscal probity upholds public faith, making every rupee spent a reflection of responsibility, not recklessness.

10. Challenges of Corruption**Quote:**

“Corruption is worse than prostitution. It destroys the soul of the nation.” – *Baba Ramdev*

Introduction:

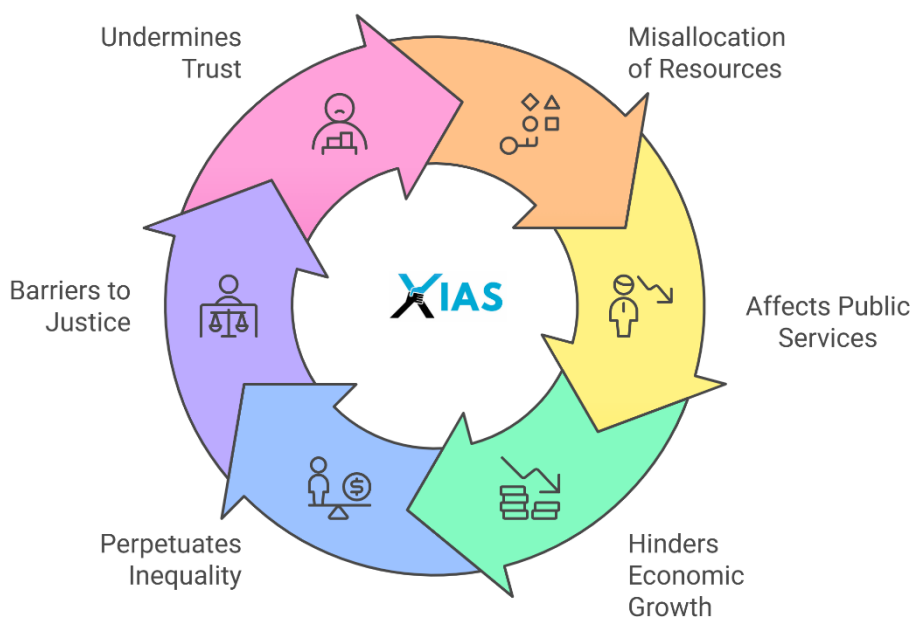
Corruption is the unethical use of entrusted power for private gain, eroding **trust**, **weakening institutions**, and distorting the **moral foundation** of public service and development.

Examples:

- **2G and coal scams** undermined resource transparency.
- **PDS and MGNREGA leakages** weakened last-mile trust.
- **PC Act (1988) amendments and Lokpal** aim to check corruption.

Conclusion:

Corruption is not merely a legal failure but a moral collapse, demanding reform, transparency, and inner restraint.

The Cycle of Corruption

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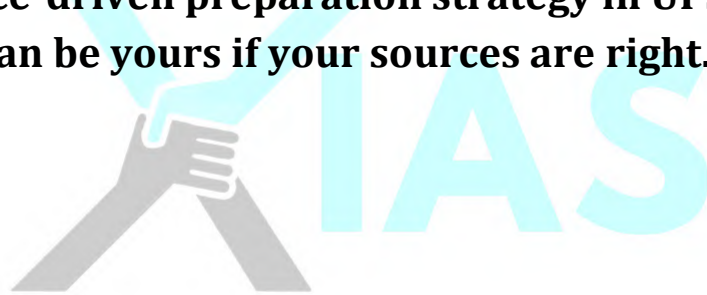
"The difference between a topper and an average aspirant is not effort it's direction."

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X IAS PRELIMS QUESTIONS 2025: HITS

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14. Who among the following rulers in ancient India had assumed the titles 'Mattavilasa', 'Vichitrachitta' and 'Udayabhara'?

- (a) Mahendravarmā I
(b) Simhavishnu
(c) Narasimhavarmā I
(d) Simhavarmā

XIAS
LEVEL-1 RTS
Class Notes
X Lecture

Mahendravarmā I was a follower of Jainism in the early part of his career. He was converted to Saivism by the influence of the Saiva saint, Thirunavukkarasar alias Appar. He built a Siva temple at Tiruvadi. He assumed a number of titles like Gunabhara, Suryasandha, Chettakani (builder of temples) Chitrakarapuli, Vichitrachitta and Mattavilasa.

He ruled from Tamralipti (port @ BoBengal) and Amaravati to Burma, and Indonesia. The ports of south India sent ships to Tenasserim, Trang, Malacca, and Java.

The ancient capital of Thailand was named after Ayodhya.

He performed various Vedic sacrifices, including the Ashvamedha.

A later group of Pallava rulers, Mahendra-varman I (600-630) was. He was a contemporary of Thanesar and curiously enough was also a dramatist and poet, of some being the author of a play, *Mattavilasa-prahasana* (The Delight of the

It was during his reign that some of the finest rock-cut Pallava temples, including the famous temples at Mahabalipuram. Mahendra-varman began

Jaina but was converted to Shaivism by the saint Appar. Mahendra-varman's play was Pulakeshin II.

Varman swept right into the capital of Badami and his occupation of the city claim to the title of *Vatapikonda*, 'the Conqueror of Vatapi'.

Varman's play *Mattavilasa* was well-known and frequently performed by the actors of

→ RTS LEVEL-2

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13. The irrigation device called 'Araghatta' was

- (a) a water bag made of leather pulled over a pulley
(b) a large wheel with earthen pots tied to the outer ends of its spokes
(c) a larger earthen pot driven by bullocks
(d) a large water bucket pulled up by rope directly by hand

Whether the Persian wheel was in use in early medieval Rajasthan is debated, and hinges on the interpretation of the term *araghatta*. The key issue is whether the reference is to the Persian wheel or to the *noria*. The *noria* is a wheel which has pots or buckets attached to its rim without a chain for carrying the pots, or a gear mechanism to ensure continuous flow of water. It could only be used to draw water from close to the surface or from a river.



→ Explained in details in BTS class (LEVEL-2)

The Persian wheel, on the other hand, had gears and a chain to carry the pots and was associated with a well. *araghatta* seems to have been different from an ordinary well (*dhimada*) or a step well (*vapi*). UPSC PYQ.

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6. Consider the following statements :

I. India has joined the Minerals Security Partnership as a member.

II. India is a resource-rich country in all the 30 critical minerals that it has identified.

III. The Parliament in 2023 has amended the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 empowering the Central Government to exclusively auction mining lease and composite license for certain critical minerals.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only (b) II and III only
(c) I and III only (d) I, II and III

MINERALS SECURITY PARTNERSHIP FINANCE NETWORK

Recent Update: India joined the US-led Minerals Security Partnership (MSP) Finance Network to secure sustainable critical mineral supply chains.

About:

- Global Collaboration: Joint financing body for critical mineral projects worldwide.
- Objectives: Strengthen Indo-Pacific and European cooperation for sustainable supply chains.
- Critical Minerals: Includes lithium, cobalt, nickel, and rare earth elements crucial for modern technologies.

XIAS
CURRENT
X-Press
Magazine

X IAS PRELIMS QUESTIONS 2025: HITS

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9. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

Circular economy reduces the emissions of greenhouse gases.

Statement II :

Circular economy reduces the use of raw materials as inputs.

Statement III :

Circular economy reduces wastage in the production process.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct and both of them explain Statement I
(b) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct but only one of them explains Statement I
(c) Only one of the Statements II and III is correct and that explains Statement I
(d) Neither Statement II nor Statement III is correct

XIAS
Current X-press
Magazine

VOLUNTARY VEHICLE MODERNIZATION PROGRAM

Recent Update: Union Ministry of Road Transport and Highways launched the Vehicle Scrapping Policy

to promote a circular economy in the automotive sector.

About:

- Circular Economy: Aims to reduce raw material consumption and encourage recycling.
- Scrappage Certificate: Provided to owners of unfit vehicles to avail discounts on new purchases.
- Incentives: Discounts of up to 3% for commercial vehicles and 1.5% for passenger vehicles on ex-showroom prices.

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83. Consider the following space missions :

- I. Axiom-4
II. SpaDeX
III. Gaganyaan

How many of the space missions given above encourage and support micro-gravity research?

- (a) Only one (b) Only two
(c) All the three (d) None

GAGANYAAN MISSION

Recent Update: ISRO has selected Gaganyaan astronauts to travel to the International Space Station (ISS) on the Axiom-4 mission, scheduled for October 2024. The mission will be a collaboration with NASA and Axiom Space, utilizing SpaceX's Dragon spacecraft.

About:

- Mission Details: The astronauts will undergo training in the US before the mission.
- Collaboration: India's space program cooperates with NASA and Axiom Space.
- Gaganyaan: India's first human space mission is expected post-2025, after successful uncrewed missions.

AXIOM MISSION 4 (AX-4)

Recent Update: Shubhanshu Shukla and Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair Selected for Axiom-4 mission.

About:

- AX-4: Fourth private astronaut mission to the International Space Station (ISS).
- Duration: 14 days.
- Launch Provider: SpaceX.

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48. With reference to monoclonal antibodies, often mentioned in news, consider the following statements :

- I. They are man-made proteins.
- II. They stimulate immunological function due to their ability to bind to specific antigens.
- III. They are used in treating viral infections like that of Nipah virus.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only
- (b) II and III only
- (c) I and III only
- (d) I, II and III

MONOCLONAL ANTIBODIES

Recent Update: Monoclonal antibodies (mAbs) continue to be widely used in diagnostics, treatments, and cell analysis, offering targeted therapies for diseases like cancer and autoimmune disorders.

About:

- Monoclonal antibodies (mAbs) are lab-made proteins designed to mimic natural antibodies.
- Antibodies are part of the immune system, targeting and destroying foreign materials (antigens).
- Key applications include:
 1. Diagnostics (e.g., ELISA),
 2. Treating diseases such as cancer, infections, and autoimmune disorders,
 3. Cell analysis in blood/tissue using fluorescent tags.

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24. Consider the following statements about turmeric during the year 2022-23 :

- I. India is the largest producer and exporter of turmeric in the world.
- II. More than 30 varieties of turmeric are grown in India.
- III. Maharashtra, Telangana, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu are major turmeric producing States in India.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only
- (b) II and III only
- (c) I and III only
- (d) I, II and III

NATIONAL TURMERIC BOARD ESTABLISHED

Recent Update: The National Turmeric Board has been launched to support turmeric production and export.

About:

- Objectives: Farmer welfare, R&D, export promotion, quality control.
- India's Dominance: Produces 70% of the world's turmeric.
- Key Regions: Maharashtra, Telangana, Meghalaya.

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96. Which organization has enacted the Nature Restoration Law (NRL) to tackle climate change and biodiversity loss?

- (a) The European Union
- (b) The World Bank
- (c) The Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development
- (d) The Food and Agriculture Organization

EU NATURE RESTORATION LAW

Recent Update: The EU Nature Restoration Law has come into force.

About:

- First continent-wide legislation for nature restoration.
- Targets to restore 20% of degraded ecosystems by 2030, and 100% by 2050.
- Member States must prepare National Restoration Plans by 1st September 2026.
- Legally binding targets:
 - 30% of terrestrial, coastal, freshwater, and marine ecosystems to be restored by 2030.
 - 25,000 km of rivers to be restored to free-flowing status by 2030.
 - Plant three billion trees by 2030.

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30. Consider the following statements about the Rashtriya Gokul Mission :

- I. It is important for the upliftment of rural poor as majority of low producing indigenous animals are with small and marginal farmers and landless labourers.
- II. It was initiated to promote indigenous cattle and buffalo rearing and conservation in a scientific and holistic manner.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

RASHTRIYA GOKUL MISSION

Recent Update:

The Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying highlighted the Rashtriya Gokul Mission (RGM) for indigenous bovine conservation and milk production.

About:

- RGM was launched in 2014 as part of the Rashtriya Pashudhan Vikas Yojna with a budget of Rs. 1400 crore (2021-2026).
- Aims to conserve indigenous bovine breeds like Punganur for climate resilience and high-quality milk production.
- Focuses on increasing genetic diversity, supporting Artificial Insemination (AI), and conservation efforts.
- Introduces National Digital Livestock Mission to enhance data management and services.

88. Consider the following statements :

- I. If any question arises as to whether a Member of the House of the People has become subject to disqualification under the 10th Schedule, the President's decision in accordance with the opinion of the Council of Union Ministers shall be final.
- II. There is no mention of the word 'political party' in the Constitution of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

POWERS OF SPEAKER

- The Speaker, elected by a simple majority, has a key constitutional role, including overseeing the House, casting votes, and dealing with member disqualification.
- The Speaker has vast powers in conducting the House, deciding on questions, expunging remarks, and ensuring impartiality in procedures.
- The Speaker's casting vote resolves tie votes, typically favoring the government.

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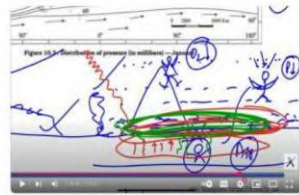
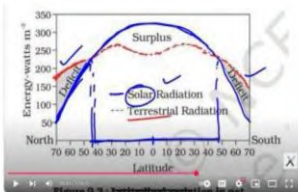
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29. Consider the following statements :

- I. Without the atmosphere, temperature would be well below freezing point everywhere on the Earth's surface.
- II. Heat absorbed and trapped by the atmosphere maintains our planet's average temperature.
- III. Atmosphere's gases, like carbon dioxide, are particularly good at absorbing and trapping radiation.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and III only
- (b) I and II only
- (c) I, II and III
- (d) II and III only



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84. With reference to India's defence, consider the following pairs :

Aircraft type	Description
I. Dornier-228	: Maritime patrol aircraft
II. IL-76	: Supersonic combat aircraft
III. C-17 Globemaster III	: Military transport aircraft

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All the three
- (d) None

ZORAWAR LIGHT TANK

Recent Update: The DRDO successfully completed the first phase of developmental field trials for the Zorawar Light Tank, designed for high-altitude deployment, especially in Ladakh.

About:

- Tested in desert terrain, met all performance goals.
- Developed by CVRDE and L&T.
- Weights 25 tonnes, highly mobile and versatile.
- Can be transported by C-17 aircraft.
- Integrates technologies like unmanned systems and loitering munition.

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27. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

In January, in the Northern Hemisphere, the isotherms bend equatorward while crossing the landmasses, and poleward while crossing the oceans.

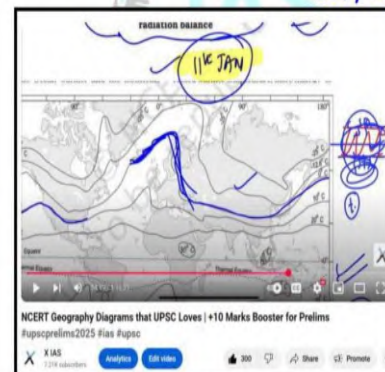
Statement II :

In January, the air over the oceans is warmer than that over the landmasses in the Northern Hemisphere.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
- (b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
- (c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
- (d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

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20. Consider the following statements in respect of the Non-Cooperation Movement :

- I. The Congress declared the attainment of 'Swaraj' by all legitimate and peaceful means to be its objective.
- II. It was to be implemented in stages with civil disobedience and non-payment of taxes for the next stage only if 'Swaraj' did not come within a year and the Government resorted to repression.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
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- (d) Neither I nor II

September 1920 At a **special session in Calcutta** the Congress approved a non-cooperation programme till the Panch and Khilafat wrongs were removed and swaraj was established. The programme was to include—

- boycott of government schools and colleges;
- boycott of law courts and dispensation of justice through panchayats instead;
- boycott of legislative councils (there were some differences over this as some leaders like C.R. Das were not willing to include a boycott of councils, but bowed to Congress discipline; these leaders boycotted elections held in November 1920 and the majority of the voters too stayed away);
- boycott of foreign cloth and use of khadi instead; also practice of hand-spinning to be done;
- **renunciation of government honours and titles;**
- **refusal to include mass civil disobedience including resignation from government service, and acceptance of arrest.**

During the Congress, the participants were supposed to work for Hindu-Muslim unity and for removal of untouchability, all the time remaining non-violent.

December 1920 At the **Haripur session** of the Indian National Congress—

- (i) The programme of non-cooperation was endorsed.
- (ii) An important change **was made in the Congress creed now aimed at lifting the attainment of self-government as its goal.** The Congress decided to have the attainment of swaraj through **peaceful and legitimate means**, thus committing itself to a **non-violent mass struggle.**

(iii) Local level preparatory changes were made: a **congress working committee (CWC) of 15 members** was set up to lead the Congress from now onwards; **provincial congress committees** on **linguistic basis were organised.**

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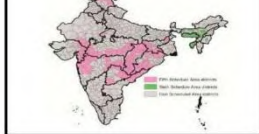
56. Consider the following statements :

- I. With reference to the Constitution of India, if an area in a State is declared as Scheduled Area under the Fifth Schedule
- II. the State Government loses its executive power in such area and a local body assumes total administration
- III. the Union Government can take over the total administration of such areas under certain circumstances on the recommendations of the Governor

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

- 10 states have notified Fifth Schedule areas, covering districts in Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha, Rajasthan, and Telangana.



PESA Act, 2006
Recent Update: A recent study has found that providing political representation and decision-making power to tribal populations through acts like PESA has supported forest conservation in India's Scheduled Areas.
About:
The PESA Act, enacted on 24th December 1996, aims to ensure self-governance for people in tribal areas (Scheduled Areas) through traditional village assemblies, or Gram Sabhas. It extends Panchayat provisions to tribal areas in Fifth Schedule states.
Legislation:
• The Act defines Scheduled Areas as those under Article 244(i), which applies to areas and tribes in states other than Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram.
• Scheduled Areas are those notified by the President as Government of India.

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56. Which one of the following launched the 'Nature Solutions Finance Hub for Asia and the Pacific'?

- (a) The Asian Development Bank (ADB)
- (b) The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)
- (c) The New Development Bank (NDB)
- (d) The International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)

ASIA-PACIFIC CLIMATE REPORT 2024

Recent Update: The Asian Development Bank (ADB) highlighted alarming economic impacts of climate change on the Asia-Pacific region in the 2024 report.

About:

- **Economic Impact:** APAC could face a 17% GDP reduction by 2070 under high emissions scenarios.
- **Country-specific Risks:**
 - India: 24.7% GDP decline by 2070.
 - Bangladesh: 30.5% GDP loss.
 - Vietnam: 30.2% reduction.
 - Indonesia: 26.8% decline.
- **Long-term Projections:** Potential 41% GDP loss by 2100.

18 of 40

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ASIA-PACIFIC CLIMATE REPORT 2024

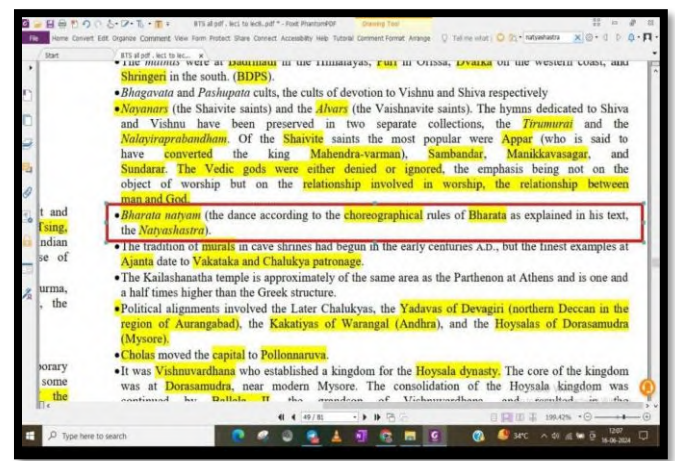
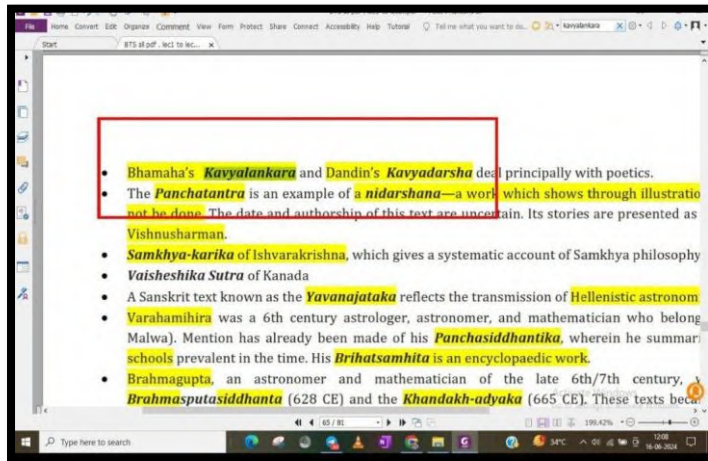
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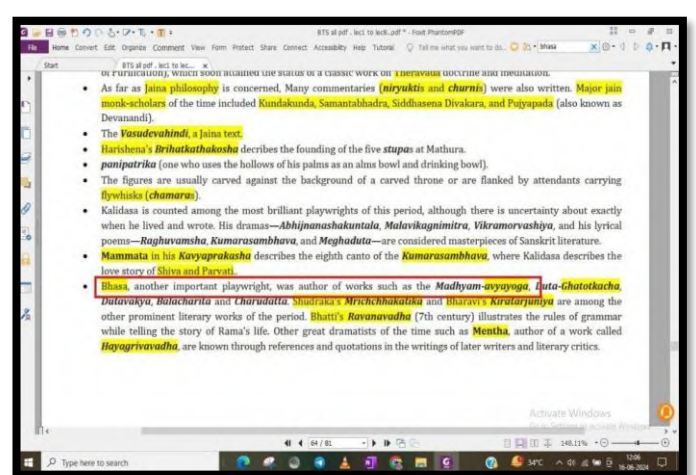
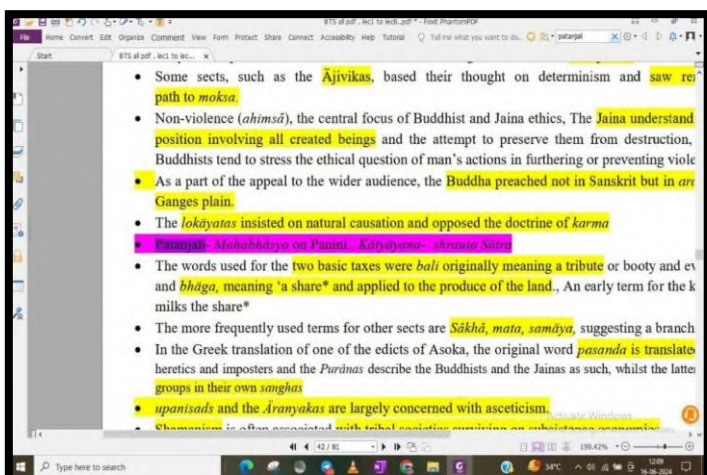
33 Which one of the following is a work attributed to playwright Bhasa?

(a) ~~Kavyalankara~~ Swapaamsha

(b) ~~Natyashastra~~ Playwright

(c) ~~Madhyama-vyayoga~~ Buddhist Tone

(d) ~~Mahabhashya~~ Ratanjali

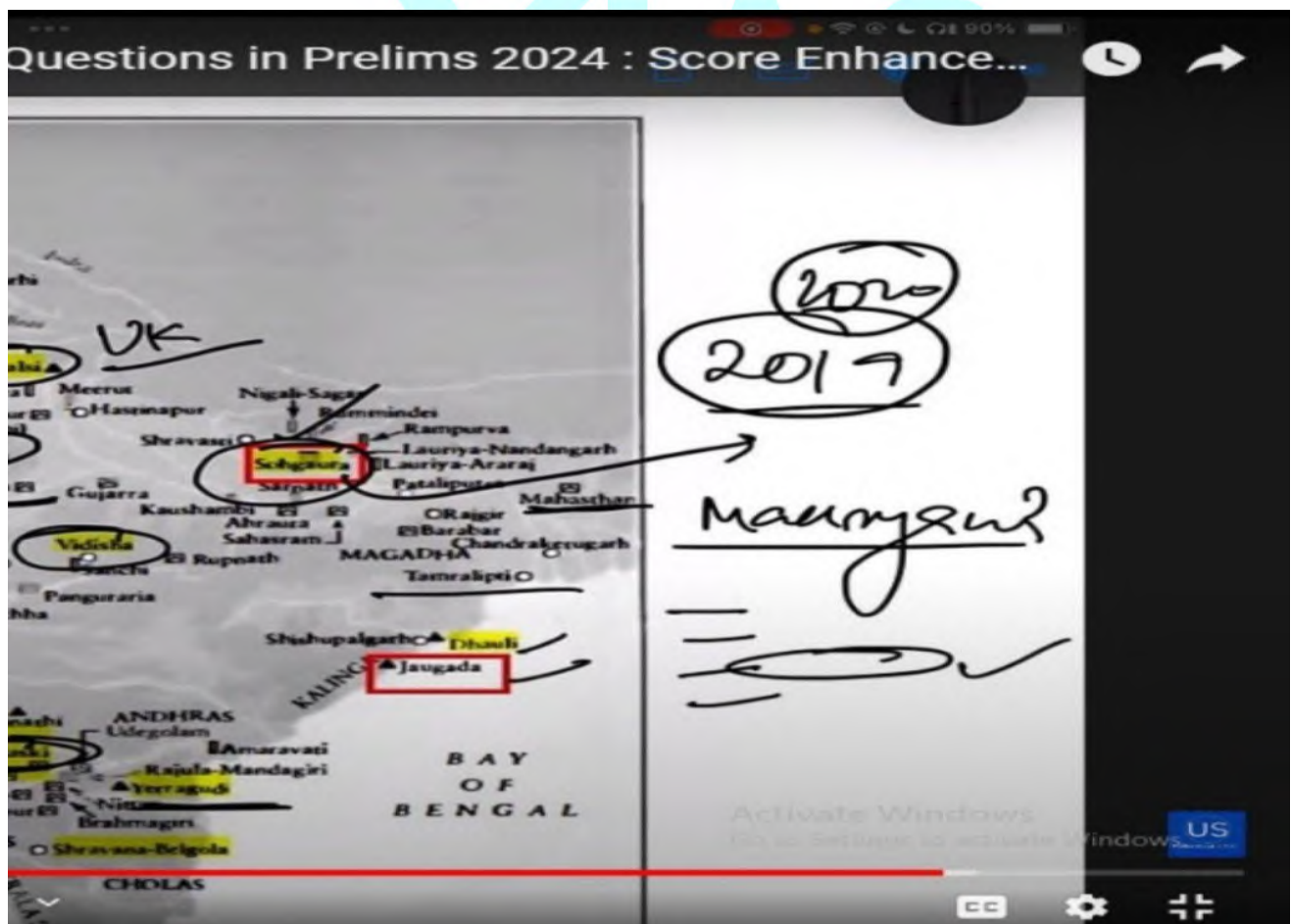
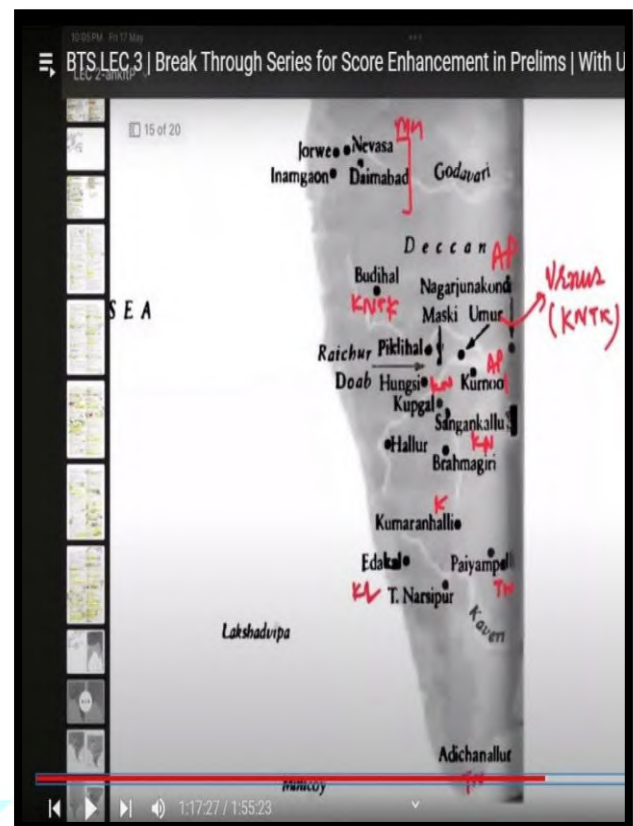


55. Consider the following information :

Archaeological Site	State	Description
1. Chandraketugarh	Odisha	Trading Port town
2. Inamgaon	Maharashtra	Chalcolithic site
3. Mangadu	Kerala	Megalithic site
4. Salihundam	Andhra Pradesh	Rock-cut cave shrines

In which of the above rows is the given information correctly matched ?

- (a) 1 and 2
 (b) 2 and 3
 (c) 3 and 4
 (d) 1 and 4

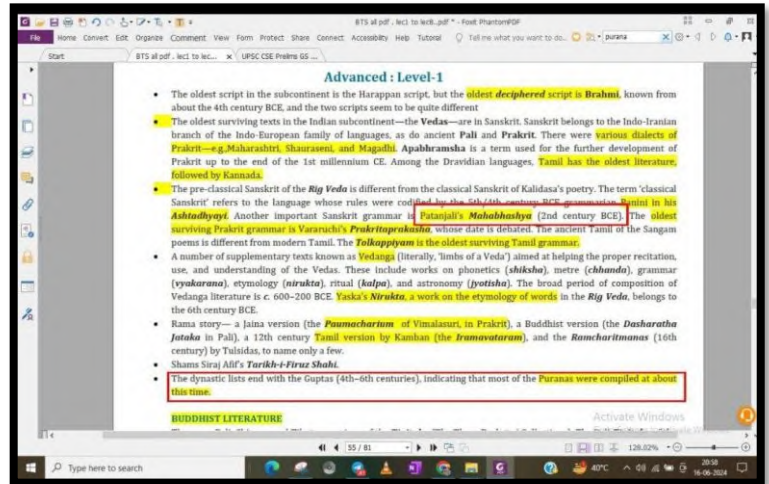


58. Consider the following statements :

1. There are no parables in Upanishads.
2. Upanishads were composed earlier than the Puranas.

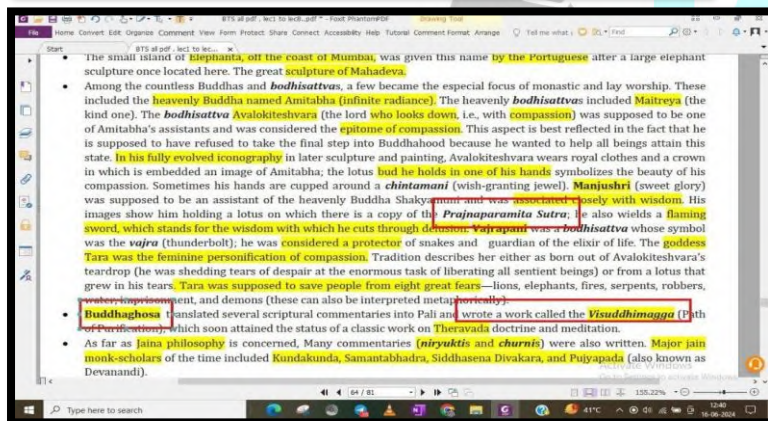
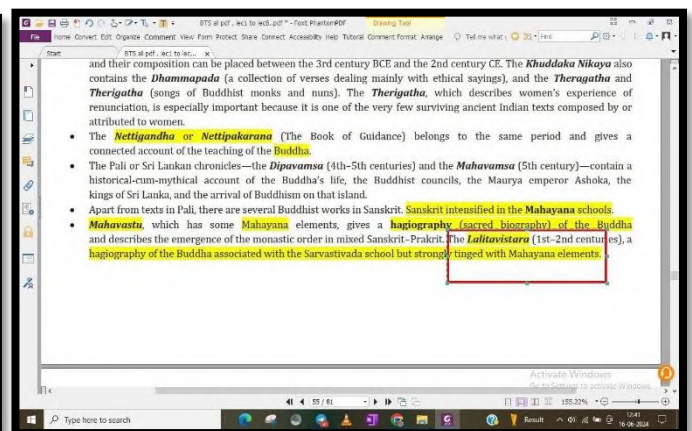
Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2



Sanghabhuti, an Indian Buddhist monk, who travelled to China at the end of the fourth century AD, was the author of a commentary on :

- (a) Prajnaparamita Sutra
- (b) Visuddhimagga
- (c) Sarvastivada Vinaya
- (d) Lalitavistara



With reference to ancient India, Gautama Buddha was generally known by which of the following epithets?

1. Nayaputta
2. Shakyamuni
3. Tathagata

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None of the above are epithets of Gautama Buddha

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